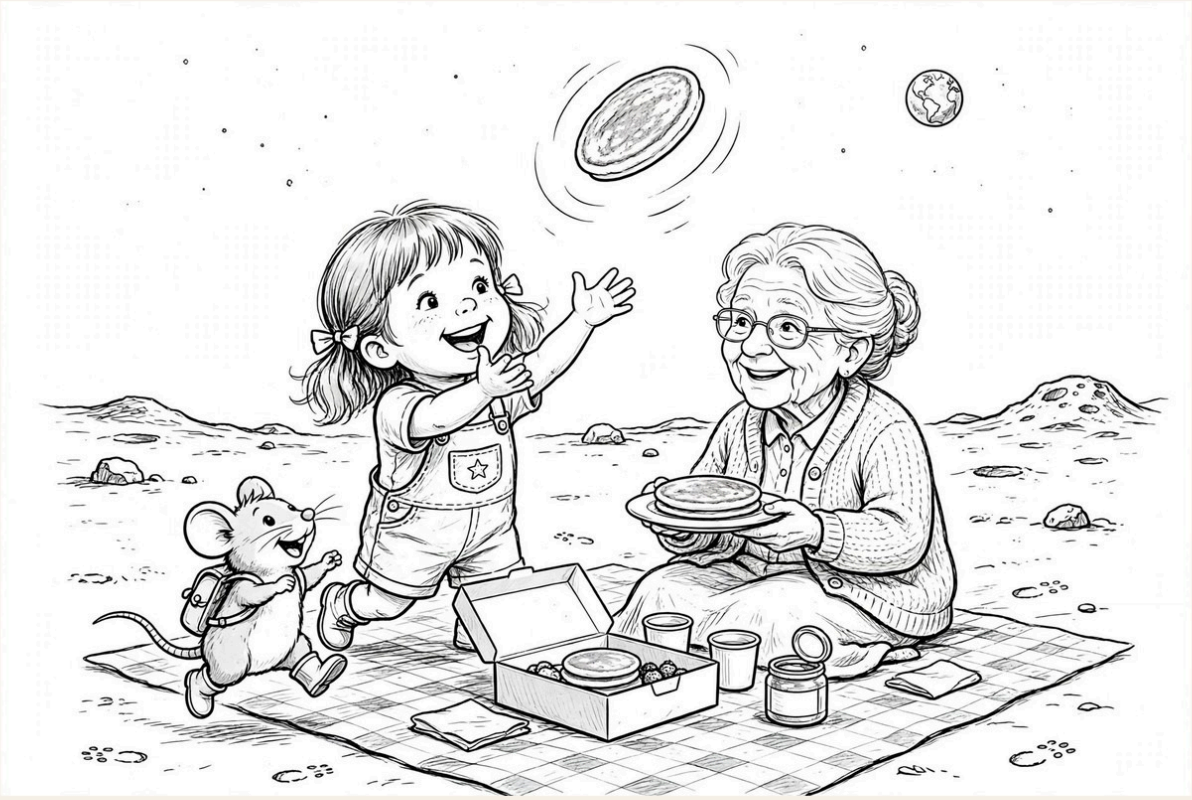
GRAMMY'S ALLIE BOOK



A STORYBOOK ABOUT ALLIE

RAMBLE EDITION

A PERSONALIZED STORYBOOK

GRAMMY'S ALLIE BOOK · RAMBLE EDITION

RAMBLEBOOK

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ABOUT THIS DRAFT

Grammy's Allie Book · Ramble Edition is a working draft, produced with RambleBook from an original story idea. It is complete as a story — beginning, middle, and end, in 6 chapters — and deliberately unfinished as a book. Chapter One is written at full weight; the chapters that follow are leaner, the way first drafts are: the bones and the heartbeat, waiting for a writer's second pass. Writing is rewriting. This is the draft you rewrite from.

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Chapter 1

The Museum of Little Things

Allie caught the top block just before it landed in her cereal.

"Not swimming time," she told it.

She set it beside her bowl of Honey Bunches of Oats. Then she pushed an empty box into her own little space with the toe of one UGG boot.

The same UGG boots as yesterday. And the day before.

Her clothes were different, but that had been the grown-ups' idea. Allie would happily have worn yesterday's clothes again. They already knew how to have fun.

Grammy watched her arrange three blocks around the box.

"What are you building?"

"A museum."

"What will go inside?"

Allie paused. Her unbrushed hair stuck out on one side. A dusty smudge crossed her cheek. Slowly, an impish grin appeared.

"Things people forget to look at."

She placed a button in the box. Beside it went a bit of ribbon and a square of cardboard covered in little squares.

"A waffle?" Grammy asked.

"A pretend waffle. A real one would be in danger."

"From what?"

"Me."

Uncrustables and waffles were Allie's favorite foods. Honey Bunches of Oats was her cereal. A museum full of those would get smaller during breakfast.

Her sister appeared beside the blocks.

"Can I come in?"

Allie held up one hand.

This was her own little space, with her own stuff. Nobody came in without an invitation. Not even her sister.

Then Allie moved one block aside.

"Now you're invited. You can help make the entrance."

Her sister stepped through the gap.

"Why is it so small?"

"So people slow down."

Grammy smiled. "You thought of that?"

Allie nodded. The blocks, the box, even the tiny entrance—she had put them there on purpose.

Her sister looked into the museum.
“We need more things.”
Allie pulled the box toward her.
“Then we’d better go noticing.”

Chapter 2

Excellent Things to Notice

Allie swung the empty box between her hands as she walked beside Grammy.

"Excellent things," she announced, "please get ready to be noticed."

Near the path, a boy crouched beside a fallen leaf.

"You can see all its veins," he told two children hurrying past.

Neither stopped.

A girl on the bench held a crooked twig. "This is a pocket-sized thunderbolt," she said.

Nobody asked to see.

Allie did.

"Does it make pocket-sized thunder?"

"Only very quietly."

"That's useful for a museum." Allie set down her box. "Would you both help us find things?"

The boy looked up. "What sort of things?"

"Things people forget to look at."

"I know some," he said.

“I know what some are called,” said the girl. “Well. What they could be called.”

Soon all three were running across the grass, with Grammy following along the path.

The boy found a seed with one papery wing.

“Maple seeds spin when they fall,” he said.

He dropped it. The seed twirled down.

Allie clapped. “It brought its own ride!”

The girl found a pebble with a white stripe.

“A very small planet wearing a belt.”

Into the box it went.

Grammy showed them a patch of dandelions they could pick. Allie chose one sunny yellow flower. Then she bent close to another without picking it.

“This one has a visitor.”

A tiny beetle climbed between the petals. They watched until it disappeared.

The box filled with fallen leaves, flowers, seeds, and the pocket-sized thunderbolt.

On the bench, Allie tried to tuck everything inside. A leaf slid out. She put it back. The twig tipped over the edge.

Grammy caught it.

“Your museum seems to be growing.”

Allie looked at her two new helpers.

“We’re excellent at noticing.”

The girl studied the overflowing box.

“Perhaps that’s a museum-sized problem.”

Chapter 3

Questions with Crumbs

Allie nudged a piece of salmon behind her bread.
She leaned left. Still visible.
She leaned right. Definitely visible.
She added a second piece of bread.
Mom looked at the little wall on Allie's plate.
"Is something hiding?"
"Possibly."
"Something pink?"

Allie peeked over the bread. "It isn't very good at hiding."

Mom made salmon so often that Allie thought it ought to know where everything was by now. Including somewhere else to sit.

"I really don't like it," she said.

"I know," Mom said gently. "You don't have to build it a house."

After dinner, Allie curled up with a book. The room grew quiet. She turned one page, then another,

resting a finger beside a picture of an enormous dinosaur skeleton.

Grammy sat nearby.

“Do museums have to have dinosaurs?” Allie asked.

“No. Some have paintings. Some have old tools or beautiful stones.”

“Who decides what goes together?”

“The people caring for the collection. They help visitors understand what they’re seeing.”

Allie tucked in her bookmark.

“Our collection mostly helps visitors see other parts of our collection. The leaf is covering the pebble.”

“That could make looking difficult.”

“And if we just write ‘pebble,’ people might think they’ve finished looking.”

Grammy brushed a bread crumb from the table.

“What would you want them to notice?”

Allie fetched the pebble and set it beside the crumb.

“The stripe. It goes all the way around. Almost.”

She turned it slowly.

Then she found some blank cards and a pencil.

“Does this stripe have an ending?” she wrote.

For the winged seed, she wrote, “How could this travel without feet?”

Grammy leaned closer.

“Now I want to find out.”

Allie reached for another card. Then she eyed the crumb.

"Do you think that's a tiny treasure?"

"Depends," said Grammy. "Is it hiding any salmon?"

Chapter 4

The Wiggle Test

Allie set three empty boxes on the porch table and balanced a fourth on top.

"A museum tower," she announced.

A cat rubbed against her ankle.

"Oh. You'd like the downstairs tour."

Allie crouched and held out her hand. The cat sniffed, then pressed its cheek against her fingers. Soon it was purring beside her.

Mom brought the dog over on his leash. He stepped eagerly toward the table, his tail sweeping back and forth.

"Wait," Allie told him softly.

She spread his blanket beside Mom's chair and patted it. The dog circled twice, folded himself down, and sighed.

"Excellent folding," Allie said.

The cat settled nearby, as if Allie had arranged the whole porch especially for cats.

Grammy sat with the baby secure in her arms.

"Our trusted helper has everyone comfortable," she said.

Allie loved helping with pet-sitting and babysitting. The grown-ups stayed close, and she knew to ask them whenever she needed help.

Now she covered her face with her hands.

"Where's Allie?"

The baby watched.

"There she is!"

A delighted squeal made Allie do it again.

Then she turned back to her tower. She gave the table the tiniest bump with her hip.

The top box leaned.

Allie caught it against her middle.

The baby laughed.

"Yes," Allie said. "Very surprising architecture."

She took the tower apart and fetched two shallow trays. With Mom, she checked them for rough edges. Then she arranged the museum treasures inside, well away from the baby and pets.

Another little bump.

Nothing tipped.

"The wiggle test," Allie explained. "A museum should pass."

She tucked a question card beside each treasure.

Grammy leaned forward to look.

Just then, a breeze slipped across the porch.

One card lifted. Another skittered. Then all the questions went fluttering over the edge.

Allie stared after them.

“The questions are leaving without their answers!”

Chapter 5

No Flying Exhibits

Allie pinned a question card beneath her UGG boot before it could skid across the park grass.

"No flying exhibits," she told it.

They had collected every runaway card from the porch. Now the wind seemed ready for another turn.

Allie wasn't.

She was wearing her faithful UGG boots, though yesterday's clothes had not been allowed another outing. Those clothes had already learned about museums. These would have to catch up.

She crouched beside the trays. Her unbrushed hair blew across her eyes. When she pushed it away, her dusty fingers left a fresh smudge on her cheek.

The boy held down a leaf with one careful finger.

"Wind can get underneath flat things and lift them," he said.

"Then we need to stop it getting underneath," Allie said. "How?"

The girl tipped the empty carrying box onto its side.

"A treasure cave."

Allie's impish grin appeared.

"With a very wide front door."

They slid one tray into the box. Its treasures stayed still, but a gust whisked through the opening and ruffled a card.

"Wrong way round," said the boy.

Together they turned the opening away from the wind. Grammy helped them move the whole setup beside a thick hedge, clear of the path.

The girl placed broad stones inside the bottom of the box.

"Cave anchors."

"Excellent," Allie said.

Grammy had brought clips for the cards. Allie fastened each question to a tray edge while her friends arranged the treasures where nothing covered anything else.

The second tray fitted beside the first.

They waited.

The hedge rustled. Allie's hair fluttered. Not one question escaped.

She gave the box a gentle nudge.

Nothing toppled.

"The wiggle test," she said. "And the windy test."

The boy removed his careful finger from the leaf. It stayed put.

Allie looked from one friend to the other.

“I needed both your ideas.”
The girl peered into their sturdy museum.
“Should we tell the wind it needs an invitation?”

Chapter 6

Admission: One Good Look

Allie moved aside and swept one hand toward the sheltered trays.

“The museum is open!”

Her sister leaned toward the entrance.

“What does it cost?”

“One good look,” said Allie. “No coins.”

The boy pointed out the tiny veins in a leaf. The girl introduced the striped pebble as a planet wearing a belt.

Allie’s sister turned it carefully.

“The belt nearly joins up!”

“That’s what the question is for,” Allie said.

Everyone bent closer. This time, nobody hurried past while someone else was talking.

When all the treasures had been admired, Grammy opened the picnic bag.

There were Uncrustables, waffle pieces, and little cups of Honey Bunches of Oats.

“My favorite kind of celebration,” Allie said.

She held up a waffle piece beside the cardboard waffle from her first exhibit.

"One of these belongs in the museum."

"And the other?" Grammy asked.

Allie took a bite.

"Too late."

After lunch, the children ran across the grass. Then Allie came back and climbed into Grammy's lap.

For a while, they simply looked.

Sunlight slipped between the leaves. A dandelion seed drifted past, carrying its tiny umbrella.

"We can't put everything in a box," Allie said.

"No," Grammy agreed.

Allie rested against her. "We can still notice it."

Later, at home, Allie set the trays in her own little space. She put the striped pebble where she could see its almost-finished belt.

Her sister waited outside.

"May I come in?"

Allie moved a block aside.

"You're invited. I need help with something important."

Together they found one empty box and placed it beside the museum.

"What goes in this one?" her sister asked.

"Nothing yet. We're saving it for our next adventure."

Her sister peered inside.

"It's very empty."

Allie looked too.
“Yes,” she said happily. “We’ve got room.”

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

RambleBook makes storybooks about the people you love, from the details only you know.

A PERSONALIZED STORYBOOK

A storybook to keep & share

Allie is 7 years old — brave, silly, kind all the way through. A keepsake storybook about Allie, made for Grammy to keep, to show, and to read aloud.